



EER292
East London
£80,000
3 months' notice

FCCA and MBA Senior finance leader with extensive experience across independent schools and academies, including Senior Finance and Bursar roles. Skilled in budgeting, financial reporting, compliance and strategic planning, with experience supporting senior leadership teams and governors in school environments. Proven track record of improving financial controls, delivering cost savings and effective financial management to support school performance and sustainability.

EER292 – Bursar / Finance Director

INTRODUCTION

A qualified professional with a strategic mindset in managing risk, pricing, procurement, investments, debt and accounts payable and receivable. In addition, overseeing financial reports, budgeting and forecasting and business development at board level.

EXPERIENCE

REGIONAL FINANCE CONTROLLER (EUROPE)

(Mar 24 – Present) Large Independent Schools Group

- Supporting numerous schools in Europe with budgeting, cashflow, monthly reporting and year end closure to achieve targeted EBITDA.
- Liaise with Group Finance Controller, Head of Finance Planning and Analysts, Legal team, Tax team and Head of Operation, Regional Managing Director, Regional Finance Director and Internal and External Auditor (BDO, PWC and KPMG).

Achievements:

- Auditing process delayed since April 24 for 4 UK Schools. UK Schools' FD was on one-month sick leave and Finance Manager of one school took 3 weeks annual leave. During my initial stage of recruitment, attended to external auditors to close the case.
- All 4 UK Schools completed their audited statutory reports and have submitted to the company house.
- Intercompany duplicated payments are now nil as I have developed a system and distributed to all schools.

BURSAR

(May 2022 to Mar 24) London Based Independent School

- Supervised HR Manager, Marketing Manager, Admissions & Marketing Manager, Estate Manager, 2 Senior Administrators and an Account Assistant.
- Responsible for two schools' operation, budget and a member of senior leadership team (SLT).
- Established KPIs and eradicated all inefficiency by tracking cash flow, analysed financial's weaknesses and strength.
- Reviewed contractors' agreement with Catering Services, IT and Transportation services and energy companies.

Achievements:

- Signed new contractual agreement for two years at fixed price transport services; saving of £144k.



DIRECTOR OF FINANCE AND RESOURCES

(Mar 2021 to May 2022) Large Secondary Academy School

- Oversaw the operation and supervised HR function, Finance Manager, Catering Manager, Site Manager, IT Manager and liaised with external payroll provider.
- Responsible for submission of 3 years' budget to ESFA and returns to ONS of employee wages and number and liaised with internal and external auditors for year-end statutory reporting. Appointed internal and external auditors.
- Presented monthly management report to the Finance and General Purpose Governors, Health and Safety Report to the Governors of Risk Management.
- Ensured information on safeguarding under the guidelines of GDPR and a member of Safeguarding team.
- Approved and authorised payroll, NI and Pension and addressed all queries related to Teacher Pension Scheme.
- Developed lettings system to serve inherent and potential clients and payments were up to date.
- Developed cashless system and implemented it with Parents Association, Social Club, Building Funds and Gymnasium.
- As a member of the Senior Leadership Team, responsible for the smooth operation of the school within balanced budget.

Achievements:

- Generated saving of £100k on variety of services bought.
- Used savings to improve road infrastructure and upgraded boilers systems at a competitive price.

FINANCE BUSINESS PARTNER

(Jan 2013 to Mar 2021) London College

- Developed short course margin costing model for the schools ie reviewed all rates and other relevant elements.
- Provided business support to Faculty Operation Officer, Estates Director, IT Director, Head of Library and Head of Alumni and Development with forecasting budgets and reported on performance £30m agreed budget FY 2020/21.
- Advised Café head their pricing strategy and addressed COVID-19 using sensitive analysis model.
- Raised queries and identified risks and opportunities with budget holders and senior management team.
- Scheduled annual budgeting meeting with 37 budget-holders, COO and Faculty Operation Officer for forecasting.
- Liaised with Research Operation Office ensured accurate calculation of staff costings on research support grants.
- Responsible for other research projects reports e.g the London International Development Centres (LIDC) £40m.
- Produced monthly and annual business survey to the Office of National Statistics (external reporting).
- Co-ordinated with the Chariot (Enterprise unit) regarding its pricing policy and staff costing monthly report.
- Liaised with auditors in adjustments for accounts at year-end for grants, consultancy services, donations etc.

Achievements:

- Previously, the school took three days to perform payroll interface reconciliation. With a new system and process, this was reduced to two hours.
- Introduced a new system in recording student numbers. This improved system reduced the process time by 40%.
- Developed a new system where it calculated various payroll funding costing, bettering time and accuracy.



FINANCIAL ACCOUNTANT

(Jan2003 to Dec2012) Large London Based Charity

- Produced year-end financial reports and month end management reports for 23 sites in the UK and one in Falkland.
- Established business plans approved by Business Board to open 13 new outlets in Germany.
- At year-end performed adjustments such as accruals, prepayment, depreciation etc for multiple units.
- Responsible for the consolidation of the statutory financial accounts for all the subsidiaries companies.
- Managed a team of 5 staff, 4 accounts payable and 1 temporary staff recruited during the year-end.

Achievements:

- Streamlined processes by establishing automated system with excel to perform VAT calculation for the Centre Managers. It took less than 10 minutes to complete the job compared with previously took them 120 minutes down 92%.
- Centralised processes and negotiated with a major food wholesale to supplies included delivering produce directly to the 20+ locations. This strategic decision drove cost of sales down by 20% per annum.

QUALIFICATIONS

FCCA (Association of Certified Chartered Accountant)

MBA (Master of Business Administration) International Business and Strategy Development

BA (Hons) Accounting and Economics

REFEREES Available upon request